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Late Startup Application Form

Summer 2020

COMPANY

Company name:

Ambient Smart Homes

Company url, if any:

http://

If you have a demo, what's the url? Demo can be anything that shows us how the product works. Usually that's a video or screen recording.

(Please don't password protect it; just use an obscure url.)

http://

Describe what your company does in 50 characters or less.

Ambient makes product

What is your company going to make? Please describe your product and what it does or will do.

Ambient plans to make a smart home product that improves indoor air quality. Our health depends so much on the quality of the air that we breathe, yet very few of us know what is in the air around us. Most smart home products focus on two things: managing temperature and automating some appliances. This is important for the energy bill and the environment, but it overlooks the most important function of our homes: providing a safe and healthy living space.

Where do you live now, and where would the company be based after YC?

(List as City A, Country A / City B, Country B.)

Singapore, Singapore / S

CONTACT

of the founder who is filling out this application:

Phone number(s):

[redacted]

Edit Your Profile

FOUNDERS

Please provide the es of the other cofounders in the startup. No need to add yours again. Founders must have at least 10% equity in the company. We will send an email to each founder to fill out additional information about themselves.

of Cofounder

Add Cofounder

Please enter the url of a 1 minute unlisted (not private) YouTube or Youku video introducing the founder(s). This video is an important part of the application. (Follow the Video Guidelines.)

https://youtu.be/jsSQxfa2Ywo

How many founders are on the team?

(Fill out this number of founder profiles)

1

CATEGORY **Which category best applies to your company?**

Fitness / Wellness

PROGRESS **How far along are you?**

I am in the early stages of prototype development.

How long have each of you been working on this? How much of that has been full-time? Please explain.

The idea itself is new. However, I have been working with IoT, clean energy, and software startups for 5 years. I plan to pursue this project full-time and switch to a part-time degree, but I need funding for the prototypes and feedback to develop it further. My university can support on

Are people using your product?

No

When will you have a prototype or beta?

August 2020

Do you have revenue?

No

If you've applied previously with the same idea, how much progress have you made since the last time you applied? Anything change?

This is my first time applying to YC and pitching this idea.

If you have already participated or committed to participate in an incubator, "accelerator" or "pre-accelerator" program, please tell us about it.

I have not participated in an accelerator, but I plan to work with my current university on developing some aspects of the technology.

IDEA

Why did you pick this idea to work on? Do you have domain expertise in this area? How do you know people need what you're making?

I have studied or worked in this field for ten years now, but recent events in the world have prompted me to explore making a business around this idea. It is very concerning that our own buildings are making us sick. Many of us intuitively know that the right temperature can have a big impact on our productivity, but there are many other elements of buildings that are overlooked. This includes having the right level of humidity, which has been shown to reduce spread of harmful pathogens such as viruses (including COVID-19). Moreover, we are so concerned about

What's new about what you're making? What substitutes do people resort to because it doesn't exist yet (or they don't know about it)?

There are four shortfalls of current indoor air quality monitoring products: they measure only one location, they are often inaccurate, and they do not provide a way to improve air quality. The cost of these alternative varies widely from $10 to $500, making it difficult for people to choose the right option for their home.

Ambient's product solves these issue through a three-part system: a network of low-energy IoT nodes, a mobile application for network management, and a cloud-based infrastructure. This three-part system overcomes the limitations of current alternatives in three ways. First, multiple nodes can measure multiple points around the home, increasing overall accuracy of measurement thanks to additional sampling points. Second, the nodes themselves will have the bare minimum infrastructure needed for data measurement, storage, and communication. This keeps the overall cost of the system very low (less than $100).

Who are your competitors, and who might become competitors? Who do you fear most?

There are several companies that provide air quality meters, but users find them woefully inaccurate or hard to use. All of them sample only one point and are usually expensive. These include products by Temtop, Awair, and Huma-i. Then there are big tech companies like Amazon or

What do you understand about your business that other companies in it just don't get?

I think most companies that make smart home products do not focus on the right problems. Automating temperature and lights are important for the energy bill and the environment, but it is unfortunately not a major concern for most people, especially those who view smart home products as a luxury. What is more powerful is the need to ensure we have a safe and healthy living

How do or will you make money? How much could you make?

(We realize you can't know precisely, but give your best estimate.)

Ambient will likely be one core revenue stream, which is simply the sale of these smart home systems through online or conventional retail channels. The size of the market is very large since it includes homes in both heating- and cooling-dominated regions around the world. Every home that uses some type of air conditioning or heating will find value in this product. Many commercial buildings have industrial HVAC systems that address some of these concerns. But with the recent shift to the gig economy and home-based working arrangements, the importance of high-quality air at home will only increase. In a nutshell, the market is big and growing rapidly. McKinsey

How will you get users? If your idea is the type that faces a chicken-and-egg problem in the sense that it won't be attractive to users till it has a lot of users (e.g. a marketplace, a dating site, an ad network), how will you overcome that?

There is certainly an economies-of-scale advantage to having more people use this product since it would drive down the unit cost. Nonetheless, the initial batch of products will be geared towards the early adopters of smart home technology. Each product functions independently at the home level so there is no pressure to sell to as many users as fast as possible. Nonetheless, the incremental step-by-step approach to reaching increasingly larger groups of people will be important. Scaling the

EQUITY

Have you incorporated, or formed any legal entity (like an LLC) yet?

No

Have you taken any investment yet?

No

If you have not formed the company yet, describe the planned equity ownership breakdown among the founders, employees and any other proposed stockholders. If there are multiple founders, be sure to give the proposed equity ownership of each founder.

(This question is as much for you as us.)

: 85%
Board: 8%
YC: 7%

Please provide any other relevant information about the structure or formation of the company.

I am still evaluating whether to base the company in US or Singapore. Both locations provide access to two key markets: North America and Asia.

LEGAL

Are any of the founders covered by noncompetes or intellectual property agreements that overlap with your project? If so, please explain.

No

Who writes code, or does other technical work on your product? Was any of it done by a non-founder? Please explain.

I am comfortable with traditional engineering and building software systems.

Is there anything else we should know about your company?

(Pending lawsuits, cofounders who have left, etc.)

No

OTHERS

If you had any other ideas you considered applying with, please list them. One may be something we've been waiting for. Often when we fund people it's to do something they list here and not in the main application.

A digital pharmacy for managing prescriptions and patient-doctor communication.
A platform that provides medical and health insights based on genetic tests, blood samples, and other medical data.
IoT device for managing electricity at the 'grid-edge' -- made more relevant my increase in solar

Please tell us something surprising or amusing that one of you has discovered.

(The answer need not be related to your project.)

I recently discovered a word which does not have any equivalent in the English language. It originally comes from Chinese but the Japanese version is more common: Yūgen. It roughly translates to elegant mystery but not entirely. It is something that is felt rather than observed. Yūgen is basically the feeling we get when we are on the shore and gaze after a boat that disappears behind distant islands. Or the feeling we get when

CURIOUS

What convinced you to apply to Y Combinator? Did someone encourage you to apply?

I spoke with several co-founders of YC-backed companies over the years and they regularly spoke about the value of the YC peer network, brand, and learning opportunities. I think it is valuable to get YC involved early on to make the most of those benefits, but most importantly to make sure Ambient is something worth building.

How did you hear about Y Combinator?

Reading Essays (many y

The application submission deadline has passed.

We're still accepting late applications for this cycle. We can't give out guarantees about when we'll review late applications but will respond to everyone who submits one.

Please ensure that this application is complete and all founders have **filled out their profiles** before submitting your application for review. The answer to **this question** must match the number of profiles filled. Once you submit your application, it will be reviewed, regardless of whether the deadline has passed or not.

Save for later

Submit Late Application